

Online advertising channels

	Pros	Cons
Display advertising 	Attention-grabbing; if ad is clicked on, success can be tracked with pay-per-click system	Hard to target consumer precisely; internet users suffer ad fatigue and ignore advertisements
Search advertising 	Good for targeting consumers, as search user keywords are matched to advertiser keywords (see pp.230–231)	Potentially expensive if using premium keywords; can take time to see results
Mobile 	Cheaper to develop content for mobiles than for computers; easy to track ad effectiveness	Different screen sizes and systems can distort ad layout; user may feel annoyed by interruption
Email 	Offers opportunity to reach millions of potential customers, especially with bulk emailing (see pp.216–217)	Recipient may delete email without reading it, and is more likely to do so if feeling bombarded
Social media 	Easy to target specific audience; offers chance of ad going viral and achieving many views (see pp.228–229)	Continual posts and updates can easily distract user's attention away from placed ad



NEED TO KNOW

- **Clickstream** User activity profile that summarizes what an individual has clicked on
- **Behavioral targeting** Process whereby websites capture data from landing page visitors and use it to improve ad effectiveness
- **Interstitials** Ads that precede the content page a user expects to land on, or appear right after it



CASE STUDY

Click fraud and botnets

With pay-per-click (PPC) advertising, a business pays a website for every click made on one of its ads, but click fraud has become a serious issue. Fraudsters set up a website and sell PPC advertising, then infiltrate the computers of unsuspecting users with a computer virus known as a "botnet" to generate fake traffic to the website. Advertisers on the site end up paying the fraudsters for the large number of clicks received. In 2013, one London company uncovered a botnet that was generating nine billion fake clicks per month.

46%

of e-commerce sales in 2014
came from the Asia-Pacific region